



Industrial robots place car frames on an assembly line.

SMARTPHONES ►

Smartphones such as the Apple iPhone, which was released in 2007, have changed the way we live our lives. We use them to access the internet, play games and music, take photos, and document our own lives on social media. On average, US adults now spend a quarter of their waking lives looking at their phones.



▲ ROBOTS

The first electronic programmable robotic arm was installed in a factory in the US in 1961. Robotic technology has since evolved, and robots are now able to recognize people and facial expressions, shop, cook, fly, play basketball, make music, perform medical procedures, and much more.



▲ THE WORLD WIDE WEB

In 1989, the World Wide Web was invented by British scientist Tim Berners-Lee. He wanted to create a space where scientists around the world could easily share information. In December 1990, the world's first World Wide Web server ran on this computer at CERN, a physics research laboratory in Geneva, Switzerland.

Sophia's humanlike hands can grasp objects.



FACT

In 2017, the humanoid robot Sophia was granted citizenship of Saudi Arabia, making her the first robot to become a citizen of a country.

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE ►

The technology that allows a computer or machine to behave like a human is known as artificial intelligence or AI. Sophia is a realistic, human-shaped robot first activated in 2016. Her AI allows her to recognize faces and show emotion, and she will get smarter over time.